

Experiment 3

Academic Year 2026-2027			
Program: Electronics Engineering (VLSI Design and Technology)			
Year of Study	Second Year	Semester	III
Course	Skill Lab: Python Programming	Course Code	VDCOR2VS201
Class	SY VLSI	Course In-Charge	Mr. Nirmol Munvar
Exp Name	Dictionaries		
CO	Apply fundamental Python programming concepts such as variables, data types, operators, and input–output statements to develop basic programs for solving computational problems.		

Dictionaries

A **dictionary** is a collection used to store data in **key-value pairs**.

Dictionaries are written using curly brackets {}.

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

Here:

"name" → key

"Rahul" → value

"age" → key

20 → value

"marks" → key

85 → value

A dictionary allows you to associate a piece of information with a name or identifier.

For example, instead of:

```
student = ["Rahul", 20, 85]
```

we can write:

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

The second version is easier to understand because each value has a meaningful key.

Important Properties of Dictionaries

Dictionaries are:

- **Mutable** — their contents can be changed.
- Based on **key-value pairs**.
- Keys must be **unique**.

- Values can be duplicated.
- Values can have different data types.
- Keys must be of a hashable type, such as strings, integers, or tuples containing hashable values.
- Dictionaries preserve **insertion order** in modern Python.

For example:

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

The keys are:

```
name
age
marks
```

The values are:

```
Rahul
20
85
```

Creating a Dictionary

The simplest dictionary:

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20
}
```

You can also create an empty dictionary:

```
student = {}
```

You can then add data to it:

```
student["name"] = "Rahul"
student["age"] = 20
```

Now:

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20}
```

You can also use dict():

```
student = dict()
```

This also creates an empty dictionary.

Dictionary Keys and Values

Consider:

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

Here:

Keys:

```
"name"
"age"
"marks"
```

Values:

"Rahul"

20

85

You can have different types of values:

```
data = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85.5,  
    "passed": True  
}
```

Values can even be other collections:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "subjects": ["Python", "Math", "English"]  
}
```

Accessing Dictionary Values

You access dictionary values using their keys.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
print(student["name"])
```

Output:

Rahul

Another example:

```
print(student["marks"])
```

Output:

85

The important idea is:

Lists use indexes to access elements, while dictionaries use keys.

For a list:

```
numbers = [10, 20, 30]
```

```
print(numbers[1])
```

For a dictionary:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
print(student["age"])
```

Accessing a Key That Doesn't Exist

Suppose:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

If you do:

```
print(student["marks"])
```

Python produces a `KeyError` because "marks" does not exist.

A safer way is to use `get()`.

```
print(student.get("marks"))
```

Output:

None

You can also provide a default value:

```
print(student.get("marks", 0))
```

Output:

0

This is useful when you're not sure whether a key exists.

Adding a New Key-Value Pair

Dictionaries are mutable, so you can add new items.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
student["marks"] = 85
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20, 'marks': 85}
```

You simply assign a value to a new key.

Modifying a Value

You can change the value associated with an existing key.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
student["marks"] = 95
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20, 'marks': 95}
```

The key "marks" already existed, so its value was changed from 85 to 95.

This demonstrates that dictionaries are **mutable**.

Removing Dictionary Items

There are several ways to remove items.

del

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
del student["age"]
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'marks': 85}
```

del removes the key-value pair completely.

pop()

pop() removes a key and returns its value.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
age = student.pop("age")
```

```
print(age)
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
20
```

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'marks': 85}
```

This is useful when you want both:

- To remove the item
- To use the value that was removed

You can also provide a default:

```
result = student.pop("address", "Not found")
```

```
print(result)
```

If "address" doesn't exist, it returns "Not found" instead of raising a KeyError.

popitem()

popitem() removes and returns the most recently inserted key-value pair.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
item = student.popitem()
```

```
print(item)
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
('marks', 85)
```

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20}
```

The returned item is a tuple containing:

```
(key, value)
```

keys()

The keys() method gives you the dictionary's keys.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,
```

```
"marks": 85
}
```

```
print(student.keys())
```

You can also use it in a loop:

```
for key in student.keys():
```

```
    print(key)
```

Output:

name

age

marks

You don't need to explicitly write `.keys()` in a for loop:

```
for key in student:
```

```
    print(key)
```

This also iterates over the keys.

values()

The `values()` method gives you the dictionary's values.

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

```
print(student.values())
```

You can iterate over them:

```
for value in student.values():
```

```
    print(value)
```

Output:

Rahul

20

85

items()

The `items()` method gives you both keys and values.

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "marks": 85
}
```

```
print(student.items())
```

You will get key-value pairs.

A very common way to use it is:

```
for key, value in student.items():
```

```
    print(key, value)
```

Output:

name Rahul

age 20

marks 85

This is one of the most important dictionary patterns to learn.

Checking Whether a Key Exists

The in operator can be used with dictionaries.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
print("name" in student)
```

Output:

True

And:

```
print("marks" in student)
```

Output:

False

When used directly with a dictionary, in checks for **keys**.

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
print("Rahul" in student)
```

Output:

False

Why?

Because "Rahul" is a value, not a key.

Checking Values

If you want to check whether a value exists, use values():

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
print("Rahul" in student.values())
```

Output:

True

len() with Dictionaries

len() tells you how many key-value pairs are present.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

```
print(len(student))
```

Output:

3

There are three key-value pairs.

update()

update() can be used to add or modify multiple key-value pairs.

```
student = {
```

```
"name": "Rahul",  
"age": 20  
}
```

```
student.update({  
    "age": 21,  
    "marks": 90  
})
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 21, 'marks': 90}
```

Notice:

- "age" already existed, so it was modified.
- "marks" didn't exist, so it was added.

clear()

clear() removes all items from a dictionary.

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
student.clear()
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{}
```

The dictionary still exists, but it is now empty.

Dictionary Mutability

Dictionaries are **mutable**.

That means we can modify their contents after creating them.

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

```
student["age"] = 21
```

The dictionary itself has been modified.

Compare this with a tuple:

```
student = ("Rahul", 20)
```

You cannot do:

```
student[1] = 21
```

because tuples are immutable.

So:

List → Mutable

Dictionary → Mutable

Set → Mutable

Tuple → Immutable

String → Immutable

Dictionary Keys Must Be Unique

A dictionary cannot have two separate values associated with the same key.

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "name": "Amit"  
}
```

```
print(student)
```

The result will be:

```
{'name': 'Amit'}
```

The second "name" replaces the first one.

So this:

```
"name": "Rahul"
```

```
"name": "Amit"
```

does not create two entries.

The key "name" occurs only once.

Dictionary Values Can Be Duplicated

While keys must be unique, values don't have to be.

This is perfectly valid:

```
students = {  
    "Rahul": 90,  
    "Amit": 90,  
    "Priya": 85  
}
```

Both Rahul and Amit have the value 90.

Dictionary Keys and Data Types

Dictionary keys need to be **hashable**.

Common valid key types include:

```
{  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    1: "one",  
    2: "two",  
    (10, 20): "coordinate"  
}
```

Strings, integers, and tuples can be used as keys when they are hashable.

A list cannot be used as a key:

```
data = {  
    [1, 2]: "numbers"  
}
```

This produces an error because lists are mutable and therefore not hashable.

A simple beginner rule is:

Dictionary keys should generally be immutable/hashable types such as strings, numbers, and suitable tuples.

Dictionaries Can Contain Lists

Values can be lists.

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "subjects": ["Python", "Math", "English"]  
}
```

```
}
```

You can access the list:

```
print(student["subjects"])
```

Output:

```
['Python', 'Math', 'English']
```

You can then use list indexing:

```
print(student["subjects"][0])
```

Output:

```
Python
```

And you can modify the list because the list itself is mutable:

```
student["subjects"].append("Physics")
```

```
print(student)
```

Output:

```
{  
  'name': 'Rahul',  
  'subjects': ['Python', 'Math', 'English', 'Physics']  
}
```

This is a useful example of **nested data structures**.

Dictionaries Can Contain Dictionaries

A dictionary can also contain another dictionary as a value.

```
students = {  
  "student1": {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
  },  
  "student2": {  
    "name": "Amit",  
    "age": 21  
  }  
}
```

You can access nested values:

```
print(students["student1"]["name"])
```

Output:

```
Rahul
```

And:

```
print(students["student2"]["age"])
```

Output:

```
21
```

The general idea is:

dictionary

↓

key

↓

another dictionary

↓

key

↓

value

Nested Dictionaries and Lists

You can combine multiple structures.

```
students = {  
    "student1": {  
        "name": "Rahul",  
        "subjects": ["Python", "Math"]  
    },  
    "student2": {  
        "name": "Amit",  
        "subjects": ["Physics", "English"]  
    }  
}
```

Accessing "Python":

```
print(students["student1"]["subjects"][0])
```

Output:

Python

Here Python performs the operations from left to right:

students

↓

"student1"

↓

"subjects"

↓

[0]

↓

"Python"

Looping Through a Dictionary

You can use a for loop to process dictionary data.

Loop through keys

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

for key in student:

```
    print(key)
```

Output:

name

age

marks

Loop through values

for value in student.values():

```
    print(value)
```

Output:

Rahul

20

85

Loop through keys and values

for key, value in student.items():

```
    print(key, ":", value)
```

Output:

name : Rahul

age : 20

marks : 85

This is a very common pattern in Python.

Dictionary Methods Summary

Method Purpose

get() Safely get a value

keys() Get keys

values() Get values

items() Get key-value pairs

update() Add/modify multiple items

pop() Remove a specific key

popitem() Remove the last inserted pair

clear() Remove everything

Some useful operations are functions rather than methods:

len(dictionary)

and operators:

key in dictionary

Dictionary vs List

This distinction is very important.

A list:

```
students = ["Rahul", "Amit", "Priya"]
```

uses indexes:

```
print(students[0])
```

Output:

Rahul

A dictionary:

```
students = {  
    "first": "Rahul",  
    "second": "Amit",  
    "third": "Priya"  
}
```

uses keys:

```
print(students["first"])
```

Output:

Rahul

Think:

LIST

position → value

DICTIONARY

key → value

Dictionary vs Set

Both dictionaries and sets use curly brackets.

A set:

```
numbers = {10, 20, 30}
```

contains values only.

A dictionary:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

contains key-value pairs.

An empty {} is a dictionary:

```
x = {}
```

An empty set must be created using:

```
x = set()
```

Dictionary Unpacking

Dictionaries can be unpacked in useful ways.

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

You can get its keys:

```
keys = student.keys()
```

its values:

```
values = student.values()
```

and its key-value pairs:

```
items = student.items()
```

Remember that these methods return special view objects, which can be iterated over.

Practice Exercises

Dictionary Basics

Create a dictionary called student containing:

name

age

course

marks

For example:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "course": "Python",  
    "marks": 85  
}
```

Print:

- The student's name
- The student's age
- The course
- The marks

Also print:

```
type(student)
```

Adding and Modifying Data

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20
```

```
}
```

Do the following:

- Add "course": "Python".
- Add "marks": 90.
- Change the age to 21.
- Print the final dictionary.

Expected result:

```
{'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 21, 'course': 'Python', 'marks': 90}
```

Removing Data

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "course": "Python",  
    "marks": 90  
}
```

Do the following:

- Remove "age" using del.
- Remove "marks" using pop().
- Print the resulting dictionary.

Dictionary Methods Exercise

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "course": "Python",  
    "marks": 90  
}
```

Use:

keys()

values()

items()

to print:

- All keys
- All values
- All key-value pairs

Then use:

len()

to find the number of key-value pairs.

get() Exercise

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20  
}
```

Try:

```
print(student.get("name"))
```

```
print(student.get("marks"))
```

Then try:

```
print(student.get("marks", 0))
```

Understand the difference between:

`student["marks"]`

and:

`student.get("marks")`

in Operator Exercise

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "course": "Python"  
}
```

Check whether the following keys exist:

`"name"`

`"marks"`

`"course"`

`"email"`

Use the `in` operator.

Dictionary Loop Exercise

Given:

```
student = {  
    "name": "Rahul",  
    "age": 20,  
    "course": "Python",  
    "marks": 90  
}
```

Write three separate loops:

- One that prints all keys.
- One that prints all values.
- One that prints both keys and values.

The final loop should produce something similar to:

name : Rahul

age : 20

course : Python

marks : 90

Nested Dictionary Exercise

Create:

```
students = {  
    "student1": {  
        "name": "Rahul",  
        "age": 20,  
        "marks": 85  
    },  
    "student2": {  
        "name": "Amit",  
        "age": 21,  
        "marks": 90  
    }  
}
```

Print:

- Rahul's name

- Rahul's marks
- Amit's age
- Amit's marks

For example:

```
print(students["student1"]["name"])
print(students["student1"]["marks"])
```

Dictionary with Lists Exercise

Create:

```
student = {
    "name": "Rahul",
    "subjects": ["Python", "Math", "English"]
}
```

Do the following:

- Print the student's name.
- Print the first subject.
- Print the last subject.
- Add "Physics" to the subjects list.
- Print the updated dictionary.

Input and Dictionary Exercise

Write a program that asks the user for:

Name

Age

Course

Marks

Store the information in a dictionary.

For example:

Enter name: Rahul

Enter age: 20

Enter course: Python

Enter marks: 85

The resulting dictionary should conceptually look like:

```
{
    "name": "Rahul",
    "age": 20,
    "course": "Python",
    "marks": 85
}
```

Then print each key and value.

Final Challenge

Write a program that stores information about **three students** using a nested dictionary.

Your data should look something like:

```
students = {
    "student1": {
        "name": "Rahul",
        "age": 20,
        "marks": 85
    },
    "student2": {
        "name": "Amit",
        "age": 21,
```



```

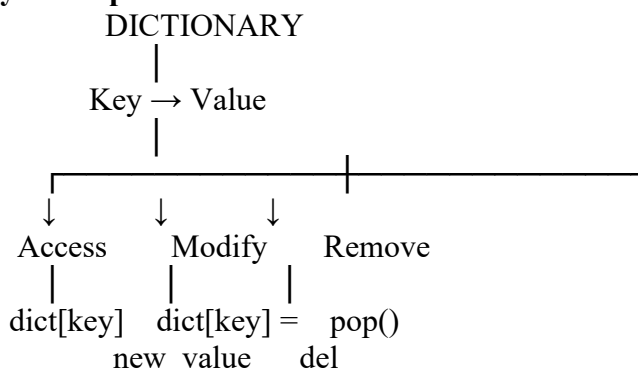
        "marks": 90
    },
    "student3": {
        "name": "Priya",
        "age": 19,
        "marks": 95
    }
}

```

Then write code to:

- Print all three students.
- Print Rahul's marks.
- Print Priya's age.
- Print each student's name and marks using a loop.
- Add a new student.
- Modify one student's marks.
- Remove one student.
- Check whether "student2" exists.
- Print the number of students using len().

Key Concepts to Master



Remember:

Dictionary → key-value pairs

Keys → unique

Values → can be duplicated

Mutable → yes

Indexing → no positional indexing

Access → using keys

in → checks keys

get() → safely retrieves values

items() → gives key-value pairs

keys() → gives keys

values() → gives values

And the overall collection picture is:

List

→ Ordered

→ Mutable

→ Index-based

→ Duplicates allowed

Tuple

→ Ordered

- Immutable
- Index-based
- Duplicates allowed

Set

- Unique elements
- Mutable
- No positional indexing

String

- Ordered characters
- Immutable
- Indexing and slicing

Dictionary

- Key-value pairs
- Mutable
- Keys are unique
- Accessed using keys

A particularly important concept to remember is:

A list answers "What is at position 2?" while a dictionary answers "What value belongs to this key?"

```
File Edit Selection View Go Run Terminal Help Skill Lab Python Programming
EXPLORER
SKILL LAB PYTHON PROGRAMMING
  Day_1
  Day_2
  Day_3
    day_3.py
    exp_3.py
  Experiments
  git-cheat-sheet-education.pdf
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
Day_3 > exp_3.py >
1 # Store information about three students using a nested dictionary
2 students = {
3     "student1": {
4         "name": "Rahul",
5         "age": 20,
6         "marks": 85
7     },
8     "student2": {
9         "name": "Amit",
10        "age": 21,
11        "marks": 90
12    },
13    "student3": {
14        "name": "Priya",
15        "age": 19,
16        "marks": 95
17    }
18 }
19
20 # Print all three students
21 print("=== All Students ===")
22 print(students)
23 print()
24
25 # Print Rahul's marks
26 print("=== Rahul's Marks ===")
27 print(students["student1"]["marks"])
28 print()
29
30 # Print Priya's age
31 print("=== Priya's Age ===")
32 print(students["student3"]["age"])
33 print()
34
35 # Print each student's name and marks using a loop
36 print("=== Student Names and Marks ===")
37 for student_id, student_info in students.items():
38     print(f"{student_id}: {student_info}")
39
Ln 20, Col 27 Spaces: 4 UTF-8 CRLF Python Python 3.14 (64-bit) 8-8 Go Live 08:35 12-08-2026
```

```
File Edit Selection View Go Run Terminal Help Skill Lab Python Programming
EXPLORER
SKILL LAB PYTHON PROGRAMMING
  Day_1
  Day_2
  Day_3
    day_3.py
    exp_3.py
  Experiments
  git-cheat-sheet-education.pdf
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
Day_3 > exp_3.py >
40
41 # Add a new student
42 students["student4"] = {
43     "name": "Sneha",
44     "age": 22,
45     "marks": 88
46 }
47 print("=== After Adding New Student ===")
48 for student_id, student_info in students.items():
49     print(f"{student_id}: {student_info}")
50 print()
51
52 # Modify one student's marks
53 students["student2"]["marks"] = 92
54 print("=== After Modifying Amit's Marks ===")
55 print(f"Amit's new marks: {students['student2']['marks']}")
56 print()
57
58 # Remove one student
59 del students["student1"]
60 print("=== After Removing Student1 (Rahul) ===")
61 for student_id, student_info in students.items():
62     print(f"{student_id}: {student_info['name']}")
63 print()
64
65 # Check whether "student2" exists
66 print("=== Check if student2 Exists ===")
67 if "student2" in students:
68     print("student2 exists in the dictionary")
69 else:
70     print("student2 does not exist in the dictionary")
71 print()
72
73 # Print the number of students using len()
74 print("=== Number of Students ===")
75 print(f"Total students: {len(students)}")
76
Ln 52, Col 29 Spaces: 4 UTF-8 CRLF Python Python 3.14 (64-bit) 8-8 Go Live 08:35 12-08-2026
```

```
File Edit Selection View Go Run Terminal Help Skill Lab Python Programming
EXPLORER
SKILL LAB PYTHON PROGRAMMING
  Day_1
  Day_2
  Day_3
    day_3.py
    exp_3.py
  Experiments
  git-cheat-sheet-education.pdf
OUTLINE
TIMELINE
Day_3 > exp_3.py >
PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS
PS G:\My Drive\Skill Lab Python Programming> python -u "g:\My Drive\Skill Lab Python Programming\Day_3\exp_3.py"
=== All Students ===
{'student1': {'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20, 'marks': 85}, 'student2': {'name': 'Amit', 'age': 21, 'marks': 90}, 'student3': {'name': 'Priya', 'age': 19, 'marks': 95}}

=== Rahul's Marks ===
85

=== Priya's Age ===
19

=== Student Names and Marks ===
Rahul: 85
Amit: 90
Priya: 95

=== After Adding New Student ===
student1: {'name': 'Rahul', 'age': 20, 'marks': 85}
student2: {'name': 'Amit', 'age': 21, 'marks': 90}
student3: {'name': 'Priya', 'age': 19, 'marks': 95}
student4: {'name': 'Sneha', 'age': 22, 'marks': 88}

=== After Modifying Amit's Marks ===
Amit's new marks: 92

=== After Removing Student1 (Rahul) ===
student2: Amit
student3: Priya
student4: Sneha

=== Check if student2 Exists ===
student2 exists in the dictionary

=== Number of Students ===
Total students: 3
PS G:\My Drive\Skill Lab Python Programming>

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```